

No. 750, May 2012

Vertigo

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz www.facebook.com/nzacwellington



Summer Rock 2012
Image courtesy of Vincent Zintzen

Next section night: 7 May, 2012

Nideng Gonnga, by Tim Church and Yvonne Pfluger

Late last year Tim Church and Yvonne Pfluger travelled to Sichuan Province in Western China to attempt the unclimbed peak Xiangqiuqieke. They encountered difficulties with the local Tibetans' religious beliefs and a range of other issues on their journey. Nevertheless, they were determined to achieve a first ascent, even if this meant resorting to Plan D. Their presentation will cover their travel story, exploration of the remote Chinese / Tibetan border areas and the climb of Nideng Gonnga (5690m).



Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

WELLINGTON ALPINE CLUB

PHOTO COMPETITION 2012

The annual Wellington Section photo competition is on. We will have a panel of excellent judges: Jean-Claude Stahl, Kate Whitley, Andy Reisinger and Fraser Crichton. The panel will present a selection of the best shots for the audience to choose the winners during our club night in June.

See your best photos on the big screen, get feedback from photography experts, vote on this year's best shots, and be in to win great prizes from our sponsors.

Entries close Sunday 27th May 2012

Photo Competition presented Monday 11 June (8.00pm) in Turnbull House

HOW TO TAKE PART

1) Pick out your best pictures for the following categories:

- Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high
- Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back
- Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way
- Rock climbing: hardest moves, slickest lines
- Photo Journalism: the shot that tells a story
- Humour: whatever gets you a laugh

2) Fill out the attached Entry Form & email to wgtnphotocomp@gmail.com

If entering slides or prints, please scan them first – we need all entries to be in digital format. Maximum of three entries per category per person – thanks!

For further info, contact Vincent Zintzen on 021 029 50307 or by [email](#).

This year's photo competition sponsored by: Bivouac, MacPac, Fergs Kayak





THE WORLD'S BEST MOUNTAIN FILMS

THE BANFF CENTRE PRESENTS
2011 / 2012

BANFF MOUNTAIN FILM FESTIVAL WORLD TOUR

Tuesday 12 June and
Tuesday 19 June 6.30 pm
Paramount Cinema,
25 Courtenay Place

Tickets:
\$18 NZAC members and students ■ \$20 non-members
Available from the Paramount Cinema, ph 04 384 4080,
and through their online booking system

www.banffmountainfestival.ca



The Banff Centre
inspiring creativity

WELLINGTON



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB



WORLD
expeditions



Adventure
South

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Banff Mountain Film Festival 2012

All bookings can be made through the Paramount: in person at the cinema, by phone (04 384 4080), or through their online booking system. Tickets are \$18 for NZAC members and students, \$20 for non-members.

Night 1 (12th June)

[ALL.I.CAN](#): THE SHORT CUT

Best Feature-length Mountain Film. Stunning time-lapse sequences, creative visuals, great skiers, and deep powder are highlights of this excerpt from the award-winning feature film that looks at snow sports and the environment.

GRAND LIBRE AU GRAND CAP

Join Arnaud Petit and Stéphanie Bodet as they attempt what might be the toughest route in the Alps, a majestic 3,900-metre pinnacle that juts from the Mont Blanc Massif: Grand Capucin. Close camera work and lively discussion along the route allow us intimate access to a refreshing and effective climbing partnership. French with English subtitles.

NARSICAME

Everything you ever wanted to know about 'Strap Induced Digitally Compressed Strapped Syndrome'

HANUMAN AIRLINES

Two Nepali adventurers channel the Hindu God of Wind on their mission to launch a paraglider from Mount Everest's summit and travel to an ocean they have never seen.

WHITEWATER GRAND PRIX

Twenty-eight of the world's most talented and progressive kayakers compete in a multi-disciplined competition on spectacular whitewater across Quebec.

REEL ROCK: ICE REVOLUTION

A revolution is taking place, led by Canadian maniac Will Gadd. After 30 years of ice climbing, Gadd has finally realized his dream of climbing radically overhanging, heinously difficult ice at British Columbia's spectacular Helmcken Falls. Gadd and Tim Emmett dodge exploding icicle bombs and send the hardest pure ice climb in the world.

SOLITAIRE

In the high desert of South America, winter takes hold, and a handful of drifters emerge from the whiteout, ready to cast their lot onto inhospitable lands and forsaken peaks. Joseph Conrad's Heart of Darkness is the inspiration for a poetic and visually stunning film that ventures beyond the frontiers of most mountain sports films.

REEL ROCK: ORIGINS — OBE & ASHIMA

There's a nine-year-old girl from New York City taking the bouldering world by storm, and her name is Ashima Shiraishi. Guided by her coach and former bouldering star Obe Carrion, this tiny master is crushing competitions and raising the bar for her peers. A trip to the bouldering mecca of Hueco Tanks provides a glimpse of the past for Obe and the start of amazing new adventures for Ashima.

Night 2 (19th June)

SEASONS: FALL

Deep canyons with steep, spring-fed creeks provide Kate Wagner with a soul-session in this paddling paradise.

THIS IS MY WINTER

Get a glimpse behind the scenes of a season with big mountain legend Xavier de le Rue. Dealing with dangers, joys, and the ups and downs of a winter spent skimming his board over steep and gnarly lines, it's all in a day's work for one of the world's finest snowboarders.

THE TRAIL COLLECTOR

People collect all kinds of things: stamps, coins, art. This is a collection of trails.

NARSICAME

Everything you ever wanted to know about 'Strap Induced Digitally Compressed Strapped Syndrome.'

COLD

Grand Prize, Best Film on Climbing. Experience Gasherbrum II in the middle of a deep, dark winter as seen from the raw, honest perspective of alpinist Cory Richard's camera. This film deftly captures the interwoven roles of pain, fear, and doubt — and reveals a harrowing descent that amplifies their isolation and exposure.

BLUE OBSESSION

The beautiful and ever-changing icefalls of Alaskan glaciers provide a stunning setting for some ice climbing adventures

TOWERS OF THE ENNEDI

The Ennedi Desert of Chad is a hot, sand-scoured, and unfriendly place. Veteran climber Mark Synnott brings young climbing stars Alex Honnold and James Pearson to the Ennedi to explore its untouched landscapes

THE FREEDOM CHAIR

Best Film on Mountain Sports. Josh Dueck was an aspiring skier and coach until a ski accident in 2004 changed his life forever. Despite his comeback and success in the world of competitive sit-skiing, he wasn't content.

REEL ROCK: RACE FOR THE NOSE

Welcome to the wildest competition known to man - the speed record on the Nose route of El Capitan. We follow Dean Potter and Sean Leary on their attempt to break this legendary record on the classic route that has been the scene of epic rivalries, brutal accidents, and remains to this day a hotly contested prize.

Summer Rock 2012

Michael Ross

When you find yourself 15 metres up a cliff-face feeling fairly relaxed about the fact that you're about to take a fall on a rope you're sure won't snap and a knot you're certain will hold that rope in place, it's easy to forget that eight weeks ago you were a little less confident. Eight weeks ago you were at Ferg's traversing the wall a foot above the ground while a bunch of strangers critiqued the bend of your arm and the twist of your toe.

But that's where we were eight weeks earlier, and hanging from that cliff is where we eventually found ourselves – on the main face at Wharepapa, getting ready to trust our belayers more than we'd normally have need to trust anybody... All thanks to Summer Rock 2012.

Nine students from almost as many different countries gathered at Ferg's on the first Tuesday in February, under the watchful eyes of six supportive instructors and one Australian Shepherd, to begin the process of learning how to

climb, be safe, and have fun. From simple movement to learning to use (and trust) our gear, to some convoluted explanations as to what a kilo-Newton actually is (something to do with apples falling maybe?). From abseiling at Titahi Bay and bouldering at Baring Head to top-roping and lead climbing at Kinloch Bay – troubled only by mosquitoes and the discovery of the world's most rancid milk in our bach fridge.

What felt like a slow process at first now seems like an incredibly quick one, as we all got to grips with the basics of climbing. By the time we made it to Wharepapa, most of our anxieties had been pushed to one side. We weren't so worried about abseiling, belaying, or whether we could even get ourselves off the ground. Instead we were sizing up leading opportunities, dangling from overhangs, and taking on 25 metre high climbs. We were, in other words, starting to feel like we might actually be climbers.



But it wasn't all about the climbing itself – there was slack-lining, good food, a few drinks, an awful lot of laughter (sometimes not even at anyone's expense), some great photography, and an introduction to the hamstring-threatening 'box game', the entertainment value of which can't be captured by mere written words.

And then, as the weather and our own tiredness defeated us on our last day at Wharepapa, there was talk about what might come next, signalling our transition from being students and instructors to just fellow-climbers. "Who's at Ferg's when?" "Who's up for a trip back to Wharepapa?" "We'll have to get you

up Tibia one day..." In other words, Summer Rock wasn't just a great welcome to climbing, but also a great welcome to the climbing community.

So thanks to Blair and our other instructors. Their time, effort and experience helped make the complex seem logical and the intimidating merely challenges to be overcome. I think I can speak for all us newbies when I say how much we enjoyed the course and appreciated their efforts. And one day, when it's you hanging from that rope trusting in our belaying, you'll appreciate their efforts too.



Douglas Peak (3077m)

Kevin Patterson and Tim Luszczak

This was one of those interesting “find a climbing partner and hope for the best” type trips. By mid-December the awful weather cycle of October-November had broken and we were getting some great forecasts. During this period Franz Josef town was so dry they nearly ran out of water – unheard of in a place where nearly 5000mm falls on average each year.

Anyway I heard on the grapevine via Paul Rogers passing through Unwin that there was a keen young man who had just spent a week doing the NZAC High Alpine Skills course and couldn't find any punters but would be here till New Years Day. I was in a similar position in Wellington, everyone was just too busy working and prepping for Christmas.

So one thing lead to another and I got on the 2am ferry and spent the next day picking up

random hitchhikers to help me drive to Mt Cook Village while I slept in the back seat. Now Douglas Peak, and pretty much anything accessible from Pioneer Hut on the Fox neve, is right up there (grade 3 and up). While I can take pretty much anyone relatively safely on such terrain, such an environment requires ‘head space’ commitment given a week or more of climbing was envisaged. So I lined up with Tim to climb Nuns Veil (grade 1+) a week before Xmas and we convincingly smashed it in a very satisfying two day trip.

The forecast looking forward was exceptional through to Christmas and beyond, so some quick 500km of driving and a chopper flight in saw us in Pioneer Hut ready to pounce on the first of our targets – the formidable Douglas Peak with its world-renowned 600m South Face



(grade 5). We picked the easier North Ridge, still grade 3, and immediately I was stunned by the melting that had occurred since my previous visit to Pioneer Hut two weeks ago – fully 1.5m of cover had been melted out by two sub-tropical rainstorms which had passed through. Snow bridge collapse was everywhere and things were really starting to open up.

Nevertheless, the next morning, on the Christmas Eve, we got up and away at 1am to climb Douglas. This was becoming the trend, to approach/climb the first four hours in the dark in order to get the best snow conditions. It made crevasse navigation extremely difficult though. Going up the face to Glacier Peak - Douglas Col in the dark, there were lots of ice cliffs/crevasses to negotiate, with tenuous snow bridges. Part way through I was almost ready to quit, so hard it was to find any way through. We did two pitches through here on the steeper stuff and achieved the Col at 6am. The North Ridge was solid and initially passed for some quick travel until we came to a 30m high rock step. Now all things being equal I'll give the rock route to an Aussie to lead any day, so this pitch was lead nicely by Tim. Then we simply made

running belays as we traversed along the west side of the North Ridge to the summit, getting there at 8am.

Not much was able to be done in terms of a summit pic as there was barely room for one! But it was a brilliant blue sky day with stunning views all around, the feeling of exposure looking over and down the South Face was awesome.

Returning back down the North Ridge to the col, we went 10 minutes further along and bagged Glacier Peak (3002m), making us up 2 x 3000m peaks for the day! We were back at Pioneer Hut at 3pm, 14 hours all up. I rate this a great climb, with lots of variety in terms of crevasse route finding, ridge travel, and a rock pitch – far and away better than Haidinger which I had climbed two weeks previously, the West Ridge of which I would regard as rather a nasty, exposed, boring face climb.

Tim turned out to be a great partner, fast on the flat, solid and safe on steep ground. And good company too. So you never know your luck when you meet up randomly.



Club trip to Pioneer hut, Westland National Park

Simon Bell

Participants: Rob Hawes (trip leader, NZAC and TTC), Lisa Wynne (NZAC), Michael Archer (NZAC), Mark Yeo (NZAC), Tony Ruzek (NZAC) and Simon Bell (scribe and photos, NZAC and TTC).

Day 1: Saturday, 3 December

We first met at NZAC hut in Fox Glacier township. Rob, Mark, Michael and I had come over from Wellington on the ferry on Friday night and spent the night in Murchison, while Lisa and Tony had both independently made their way to the West Coast.

Our plan, to fly in straight away, was sidelined by the ominous clag which had started to gather around the Fox glacier. The first helicopter trip made it halfway up the glacier before turning back. Grounded! My mind returned to the long breakfast we had in Greymouth and I wonder if this stopped us from making it to Pioneer Hut today. We spent the day lounging around in the NZAC hut.

Day 2: Sunday, 4 December

We fly in and make tracks to the base of Haidinger. Forecast for the week is looking pretty good.

Day 3: Monday, 5 December

We all climbed Haidinger via the west ridge (grade 3). Things went smoothly on the way up. From hut to summit in just over four hours, despite poor visibility and covering steep and exposed ground. We took one pitch to get up the final snow / ice gully and had a bite to eat on the summit.

The fun began when we rapped off. We got the double ropes stuck. I climbed up to sort them but when I rapped down they were stuck again!

Rob climbed up again and changed anchor. The lesson here being that we had used existing slings, which, while looking to be in great condition, were too tight and wouldn't let the rope be pulled through at all. In the meantime, the others were standing around on steep ground in the shade getting cold!

After this, the ground that we had more or less happily climbed up looked very steep and we did some further raps, with the more confident members taking the snow stakes out and down climbing. The terrain eased off eventually and after a lot of down climbing we arrived at the base of the mountain in time for a late lunch and a easy walk back to Pioneer Hut.

Day 4: Tuesday, 6 December

The weather looked average due to the westerly system of high winds. The others eventually decided on a half-day trip to Halcombe (North Couloir, 3-), which should be reasonably sheltered. I decided, based on the weather, they wouldn't make it and stayed in the hut. To my dismay they returned several hours later having succeeded (although they didn't quite top out proper due to being blasted by high winds when they hit the summit ridge.)

Day 5: Wednesday, 7 December

Wednesday was also a bad weather day and I wished I'd ventured out to climb Halcombe with the others on Tuesday!

Day 6, Thursday, 8 December

Glacier peak (grade 2+) looked very steep when we approached it in the dawn. Rob assured us that it would look less steep once we got closer. Fortunately, he was right and we had no real issues climbing to the summit. The terrain



didn't require pitching and the crevasses were huge but easy to avoid. Douglas looked quite imposing from Glacier peak, and we were only climbing the 'descent route'! (still a Grade 3-!). The only serious obstacle was a 30m rock step which we pitched. The snow ridge after this was straightforward but exposed. On the summit we stuck our head down to look at the South Face in horror (I was told at the hut that the grade 5 ice routes were in great condition!)

Day 7: Friday, 9 December

Friday was only ever meant to be a half-day. Rob, Lisa and myself headed off to 'have a play' on Haast with the vague idea of getting to West Peak (3065m). The others decided to spend Friday resting in preparation for an ascent of Tasman the following day. We were at the start of our chosen route (Route 14.53, grade 3) just on day break. The climb is up a steep snow couloir which later links into the West Ridge proper and the fun rock section begins. The ridge was mostly rock scrambling although we did two shortish pitches to get up a slab and, later, a difficult one-move wonder.

We found a flat section maybe 100m from West Peak, had lunch and decided to call it a day. As we hadn't topped out on West Peak (and the common descent route), we rapped down part of the route then rapped off the west of the mountain onto steep snow. We eventually arrived back at the hut around 6pm (after 12 hours on the go). So, yes Rob, technically a half-day still! Not quite a success summit-wise but a great day out nevertheless, and we felt we had completed the crux of the climb (only a complete traverse of Haast would confirm this – anyone keen next year?)

Day 8: Saturday, 10 December

This was it! Last climbing day and we left Tasman till the end. Owing to the 'half-day' Haast experience, a late-ish dinner and our early start (midnight) I ended up with a total of two hours 'bed time' before getting ready for the super summit.

We had heard the conditions on Tasman were not great due to a huge chunk of the north shoulder of Tasman having fallen out a few

weeks prior, leaving behind rock and a steep ice cliff. We had also seen a party successfully climb Tasman the day before, but still being high on Lendenfield around 8pm. The freezing level was above 3000m. We didn't let any of this worry us, and headed off in the slush towards Haast corner at a cracking pace.

We successfully climbed Lendenfield (grade 2) and headed down to Engineer Col to inspect the North Shoulder. It was barely light, but already the shoulder looked imposing. We decided to wait 15 minutes until it was lighter to get a better look. We were still not too happy with what we saw and after a vote (with only 3 in favour of continuing) we made a relaxed retreat and snapped some amazing pictures of the dawn.

Back at Marcel Col we contemplated climbing to the high peak of Haast (only 150m vertical to the summit) but decided to cut our losses and headed back.

In hindsight, the decision to turn around from Tasman was the right one. During the descent we bumped into the party who had climbed Tasman the day before and tented below Engineer col. They had ran into problems with the high freezing level and had to pitch most of the way down Tasman, despite having climbed up most of it solo in the morning.

We returned to Pioneer hut around 8am, flew out just after 10am, had a shower courtesy of NZAC hut in Fox, drove to Picton, caught a late ferry and were back in Wellington by 1:30am! While lying in bed, I tried to imagine what would have happened if we had decided to carry on. Would we still be on the mountain now, at 1:30am? Given the progress of the other party, almost certainly! I was happy to lie in my bed in Wellington and recall the awesome climbing week, without having a final epic – save that for next time!

Thanks so much for organising the trip Rob. Looking forward to the GTT trip this year!



Central Direct, Otira face, Mt Rolleston, Easter weekend

Richard Davidson

Of late I've devised a system of strikes, a "strike" being defined as a significant negative deviation from my plan. Two strikes and I think about retreat; three strikes and we're out. On Easter Friday, we suffered our first strike as soon as we got out of the car.

The group was me, Julian Davidson, Lans Hansen and Ed Denton, and our objective was the Central Direct route on the Otira face of Mt Rolleston, Arthur's Pass National Park. We parked at the start of the Bealey Valley Track at 6am and began our climb to the base of the Otira face. Forty minutes later, with the Otira face looking decidedly strange and unlike what we had seen in the photos, we questioned whether we were, in fact, on the right track. A quick glance at the map told us we needed to be one valley over, in the Otira Valley. Strike one.

Well aware that we had plenty of opportunities to notch up more strikes, we hurried back to the carpark, drove down the road, and sped up the valley to the base of the Otira face. We were on the route at 9.30am, 1.5 hours later than I wanted to be, but still with enough time if we moved quickly enough.

I had expected the face to look a bit more daunting than it did, so we started out in a good frame of mind, fairly relaxed about the climb. Of course, it helps your mindset no end to have a perfect day with no wind and not a cloud to be seen. Out of two choices to start the route, we headed to the right to see if we could make our way up a deep notch which led to the route proper (the other way being slippery, mossy bluffs). This line was fairly straightforward except for a difficult ten metre section which had no protection. In what was to become his first of three solid solos that day, Lans danced his way up the pitch without a problem. He then brought the rest of us up on the rope.

This led us to the perma-snowpatch adjacent to the main rib of rock which runs up most of the face, until it joins the Phillistine-Rolleston ridge which leads to the summit of high peak. With the sun on our backs, but a little conscious of our shortened time, we began the ascent of the rib. The climbing was a mix of nice scrambling and the occasional difficult move made harder by some solid exposure. According to Graeme Kates, author of the Arthur's Pass guidebook, the rock grade is 12-14, with exposure of be-



tween 400 and 800m at times. We would say this is about right, although we didn't find the exposure too bad, and the parts that are grade 14 are limited.

Midway up the rib, and in a particularly exposed part, Ed was holding himself on what looked like a big stable rock when it shifted suddenly. Ed managed to keep his balance, but it was a scary reminder that you need to check all holds on this sort of climb very carefully. Otherwise, the climb up was without incident. We pulled the rope out a couple more times for short sections on the basis of a "better safe than sorry" attitude. Depending on your competence on rock, and head for heights, this route is definitely soloable.

We didn't spend long at the top before we started moving east along the high peak ridge. We had been advised that it's best to go to the end of the ridge at which point you downclimb an obvious five metre crack over the full exposure of the Otira face and onto a "catwalk". From this catwalk you can abseil onto the Crow Glacier if possible or onto the col between high and mid peak. Having not carried our crampons with us (important to keep the pack as light as possible for this climb) and doubting whether we could access the glacier with a big schrund at this time of the year, we rapped down to the col and then traversed mid peak. The traverse is not especially fun – a lot of loose rock and quite a bit of exposure – so we would recommend accessing low peak via the glacier if at all

possible. Once at low peak, we descended via a complex set of ledges through the Otira slide. This is normally a straightforward route when there is plenty of snow, but we found it quite a tricky section to negotiate.

Once down in the Otira valley, we walked out under a beautiful full moon with the jagged peaks of Arthur's Pass silhouetted against the darkening night sky. A brilliant day, a classic route. Highly recommended.

The next day Lans and Ed headed out to Castle/Flock hill to resume the bouldering they had been doing prior to our arrival. Julian and I headed up the Waimak river to Carrington Hut with Mt Murchison our objective. After a night at Carrington, we tried in vain to cover the 7km and 1650m height gain (all over ankle-twisting rocky ground) to the summit of Murchison but it just wasn't within our reach. We got to the start of the glacier that leads to Kahutea col (400m below the summit), looked at our watches, listened to our bodies, and decided to turn around. Our climb of the Otira face had been a long day and, personally, my fitness was lacking. The body had never really caught up and in hindsight we should have pulled back on our objective, maybe Mt Franklin.

All in all though, we had a cracker of an Easter weekend with stunning weather and we counted ourselves lucky to have been out and about in the hills. There was nothing else we could have asked for.



Upcoming Club Trips

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

And remember we love to hear about your trips – send stories to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

6–8 July: North Island Ice Climbing Meet – Tukino Lodge (Mt. Ruapehu)

Trip organiser: Adam Power

This is a six day ice/mixed climbing trip to Mt. Ruapehu. The plan is to spend three nights at Ruapehu Hut and three more nights at Tukino Lodge to join the North Island Ice Climbing Meet. Participants are welcome for part of or the whole trip. Climbers should have ice and or mixed experience or must have robust alpine experience and be eager to learn these techniques. Possible routes and areas include: Barium Enema Face, Cathedral Rocks, East Buttress of Girdlestone, Chiming Bells and many more.

For information and sign up contact Adam at adamipower@yahoo.com or 021 0269 8151



Cathedral Rocks (photo by Adam Power)

August 2012: Mt. Murchison (Arthur's Pass)

Trip organiser: Mark Hooker.

28–30 September: North Island Ski Touring Meet – Tukino Lodge (Mt. Ruapehu)

Trip organiser: Magnus Hammarsal at hammarsal@gmail.com (Auckland Section).

Notices

Unwin Lodge nearly 'winter solstice' dinner 16th June 2012

Come to Aoraki-Mt Cook for a three course dinner, guest speaker and to check out your revamped lodge. \$45.00 per person includes accommodation Saturday night, three course evening meal from 5:30pm and a complimentary glass of mulled wine – bring your own drinks.

Try out the upgraded Mueller Track, check out new routes on Sebastapol, and inspect the new bridge on the Hooker Track. Steve August, inventor of the now famous Kiwi Hot Tub, will be bringing one to Unwin for you to enjoy. One limerick, with a mountain theme, will be required from each person attending. Limited to 48 people.

Please contact Chas or Katrina at Unwin to book your place for this must do event. 03 435 1100 or unwin@alpineclub.org.nz

Banff Palmerston North

Palmerston North Banff tickets are now available online.

Date: Saturday June 16th

Time: 7.30pm (doors open 6.30pm)

Venue: The Globe Theatre, 312 Main Street, Palmerston North

Price: Member: \$20; Non-member: \$25 (NOTE: only two tickets can be purchased at the member price, subsequent tickets will be charged at non-member rates)

Ticket sales: online at <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/banff-film-festival-palmerston-north-16th-june-2012> or by contacting Mike 021 1067 1492, or Sean 021 478 498. There will be limited box office sales on the night.

Films:

- All I Can - the Short Cut
- This is my Winter
- Solitaire
- Hanuman Airlines
- Narsicame
- Towers of Ennedi
- Ice Revolution
- Race for the Nose
- Cold

Dear NZAC member,

The NZAC exists to support and foster climbing at all levels.

After just two weeks in the role as General Manager, I am beginning to appreciate the extent and breadth of activity undertaken by the NZAC, to achieve that end. It has been hugely enlightening and humbling experience to meet and talk to the numerous members and stakeholders of NZAC, who are day-by-day, weekend-by-weekend indulging their passion for their sport and their club. When interviewing for the role, I made the commitment to the President, Stu Gray, that I would initially focus on what I thought were the three major 'touch points' that the majority of the membership has with NZAC – Accommodation, Instruction and Publications.

In the few short subsequent weeks that I have spent 'getting me feet under the desk', the extraordinary range and depth of other activities that we do in addition to those core activities, has become apparent. Expedition funding, access to crags, travel insurance, bolting, political advocacy and even maintaining a library are just some of the things that the NZAC and its members get stuck in to. I am looking forward to delving more deeply into these areas in coming months.

In the meantime, please read below for some updates on various goings-on:

Winter Instruction

As well as the various snowcraft and basic alpine instruction courses being offered by Sections this winter, there are several professionally-instructed courses being organised by NZAC. Check out what is on offer at: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine>

There are limited places left on the Progression to Leading on Technical Ice (June 30-July 2nd) and Mountain Skills for Youth (June 30-July 2nd) courses. There is a scholarship available for the Youth course. Check the website for details.

The Introduction to Back Country Skiing Course (September 1th -7th) has only two spaces left on it... so get in quick! Contact Pat at: pat@alpineclub.org.nz if you have queries.

Ruapehu Hut

Unfortunately, the Ruapehu Hut on The Whakapapa Skifield is not compliant with DoCs requirements regarding the disposal of human waste. As a consequence, Ruapehu Hut will be closed for the winter. Obviously this is a disappointment for members wishing to use it for the winter climbing and skiing season, the Section instruction courses which have traditionally based themselves there, as well as the numerous schools and groups that were scheduled to take advantage of what is a great facility. It is supremely important that the work to bring the hut up to compliance, is completed next summer. As custodians of the hut, the Auckland Section will continue to lead that project.

As an alternative, NZAC has negotiated with the Tararua Tramping Climb and the Hut Valley Tramping Club, to secure access to their Ruapehu lodges at membership rates. Bookings can be made by their respective processes at <http://www.ttc.org.nz> and <http://www.hvtc.org.nz> When booking, let it be known that you are an NZAC member and wish to book at the member rate.

Whangaehu Hut

Another obvious alternative for NZAC accommodation on Mt Ruapehu is Whangaehu Hut, perhaps used in conjunction with Tukino Lodge. (alpineclub.org.nz/hut/tukino)

Whangaehu Hut is ready for business again - a massive effort from our volunteer team over Auckland anniversary and Waitangi weekends has polished off most of the major work. So get up the hill and enjoy Whangaehu like you've never seen her before - basically brand spanking new, inside and out. alpineclub.org.nz/hut/whangaehu One final working-bee weekend is scheduled this weekend (28th – 29th April), to finish the refurbishment. Coincidentally, scheduled at the

same time as the Wellington Section is working on the Tukino Lodge, it will be great chance to meet other club members and enjoy the mountain. If you are available to help out, please make yourself known to the organisers via the NZAC website. Trade skills not essential – the ability to walk uphill with a pack on is equally valuable!!

Creative Writing Short Story Competition

To celebrate the 80th edition of The Climber, the NZAC and Macpac are hosting a Creative Writing Short Story Competition open to all readers of the magazine. The winning entries will be announced and published in The Climber edition 80. Deadline for handing in your story is 5pm on May 7th. Great prizes on offer as well as literary glory. Check out the conditions and prizes on: www.alpineclub.org.nz/the-80th-issue-climber-creative-writing-competition

NZAC Photographic Competition 2012

Get out those cameras! The annual NZAC Photocomp opens for entries on May 14th. Accepting digital entries and slides. As per usual, there will be a large prize pool and the opportunity for your image to appear in the 2013 NZAC calendar.

Guidebooks

Members will be glad to hear that the previously sold out edition of New Zealand Backcountry Skiing by James Broadbent is being reprinted and will be available in time for winter, from May 7th. As a special pre-winter offer, we are selling New Zealand Backcountry Skiing and Avalanche Awareness in the NZ for a special combination price of \$40. This will set you up for winter pretty well, so take advantage at:

Department of Conservation policy on Bolting

DOC have recently drafted a proposal to provide a nationally consistent position on bolting. It draws heavily, almost exclusively even, from the NZAC Bolting Guidelines document and holds NZAC as the key stakeholder and oversight body. You can see the draft document here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2012/doc-draft-proposal-for-national-consistency-on-fixed-anchors> Please take a look if you are at all interested and send me your feedback.

National Route database

www.climbnz.org.nz sits in the suite of websites run by NZAC. The goal is to have every route, both mountaineering and rockclimbing, in New Zealand, online. So far, there are over 7000 routes inputted. Check your local crag or favourite alpine area and feel free to get involved. It is a fantastic resource.

Finally, I would like to thank all those people who have made contact with me and made themselves known. The messages of support have great!! If you haven't already, get in touch by phone, e-mail or call in at HOMS if you are in Christchurch. I appreciate any opportunity to engage with members and hear about what interaction you have with the club.

Failing that, I will see you out there in the vertical places..... easily recognisable – I am the one complaining that it is too steep.

Regards

Sam Newton

General Manager – New Zealand Alpine Club

Summer Rock - a retirement

After nine years being involved with Summer Rock I have decided that it is time for a break. I will be taking next year off and maybe a few more, so the club will need someone to put their hand up to run the 2013 Summer Rock. I am happy to mentor and pass on my knowledge.

In 2004 I had just moved to Wellington from Christchurch and did not know anyone. I saw this as a good time and opportunity to try something new and do something I always wanted to do. In my boredom and wandering I was in the Wellington Public Library and saw a flyer for a Spring Rock run by the NZAC. With nothing to lose I thought that I would give rock climbing a go. It was on this course that I met Yibai, Michele and Scott Taylor. 2004 was the first time that I was on real rock and I loved it!

The following year, 2005, I was asked to help out as an assistant instructor, it was this year that the course was changed to focus more on lead climbing. We wanted to give the students an experience and the skills to go climbing anywhere in NZ on a sport route. In 2006 I carried on with the course and began to help Scott Taylor with running Summer Rock, since then I have been involved in running the course. I have learnt heaps and every year you learn something new. My involvement in Summer Rock has given me opportunities and confidence that has transposed in to life outside of climbing, work. My time with Summer Rock has been a fun and I have met heaps of cool people and now have a group of great climbing partners and friends. Best of all it was through my involvement in the Club that I met my partner in crime Nicky. Other highlights have been doing the Outdoor First Aid course (the club runs these every year and I highly recommend that you do one for yourself) and having the chance to go down to the Darren's with Paul Rodgers to learn more about instructing and climbing.

I would like to take this opportunity to thank Scotty Taylor for teaching me everything he knows and for helping shape and mould the course to what it is now. I would like to also thank Don French and Garth London for their guidance and support during this time. The course would not be what it is without the students all 80+ of them and the instructors who have helped me out. To Robin and Shane, a special note of thanks for their effort and contributions over the past few years.

I will miss the course as I have got more out of it than I have put in. I look forward to passing the torch on to the next sucker/volunteer.

Cheers

Blair

2012 International Climbers' Meet, Yosemite

The American Alpine Club is hosting its annual International Climbers' Meet. We would like the NZAC to extend an invitation to all of its members to participate in this annual event to be held the week of Oct 8 - October 13, 2012 in Yosemite Valley. Experience with placement and removal of protection, multi-pitch rope management, at least two years of technical rock climbing, and the ability to follow sustained 5-8 granite is mandatory. The goal is to host a diverse group of climbing abilities from a multitude of countries. American Alpine Club members from the USA will be participating again this year.

The fee is \$450 USD per person. Participants provide their own transportation to Fresno, California airport. Your fee includes:

- Pick up Fresno airport October 7 by 7:00pm local time, drop off at Fresno airport October 14 by 11:00am local time.
- Transportation in Yosemite Valley
- Six nights and days camping at secluded Yellow Pines camp ground
- Three catered meals per day
- Five and one half days of climbing in spectacular Yosemite Valley
- One half day of a stewardship project for Yosemite Valley National Park
- Nightly campfire for storytelling, socializing, and general carousing
- Partner with other participants or experienced host climbers

Last year's meet was a rousing success. Participants enjoyed climbing everything from all day long routes to challenging short climbs. We hosted climbers of all abilities from more than eight different countries. Accounts of the day's adventures were shared every evening over dinner, beers, and the glowing campfire. Come join the fun in the premier American climbing area of Yosemite Valley.

Deadline for applications is June 10. For more information go to: <http://www.americanalpine-club.org/p/internationalclimbersmeet>

Kyrgyzstan expedition

I am in the very early stages of planning an exploratory expedition to the Western-Kokshaal-Too region of Kyrgyzstan (bordering China). The objective is to explore new routes and lines east of the recently explored Sarychat glacier area named the Pal Gov glacier. There are around five or six virgin peaks in this area (as far as my research shows at the moment) with a vast array of new route potential.

I am after names and contact details of anyone who is familiar with organising expeditions to the Tien Shan who may be able to offer some advice (of any sort) about the region and logistics in this area.

September and July have the most settled weather in these regions, with July having warmer temperatures, thus July 2013 would be an ideal time and four weeks seems like it will give enough time. Further to this I would like to extend an invitation to suitably competent climbers/alpinists who may be interested in joining this expedition, to make an expression of interest.

I know this is very brief but as mentioned I am in very early stages of planning and am hoping that interested parties will be happy to share the planning and preparation. Feel free to call me on 021 0269 8151.

Adam Power

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Hinrich Schaefer	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	vacant		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
	Nina Sawicki	NS	
	Dan Pringle	DP	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	Fraser Crichton		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Jeremy Tries	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz



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